

ZAIRA CHRISTA BARAKAT

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PROFILE

Brand strategist and cultural researcher completing an MA in Cultural and Creative Industries at King's College London, following a BA in Music at Oxford. Combines qualitative fieldwork with practical experience in hospitality operations and creative direction. Developed a listening-bar positioning proposal, researched belonging in Tokyo's underground music scene, and coordinated creative and marketing work for the Oxford Fashion Gala. Currently leads the gradual implementation of brand work at The Reach Brasserie. Seeking a brand strategy role that brings together cultural insight, clear recommendations and creative collaboration.

EDUCATION

King's College London – MA Cultural and Creative Industries	2025 - 2026
University of Oxford, Somerville College – BA (Hons) Music, 2:1	2022 - 2025

EXPERIENCE

Zaira Christa Fashion Label <i>Founder and Creative Director</i>	London 2022 - Present
- Founded an independent fashion label and brought two seasonal collections from initial concept through to runway presentation, directing all creative, production, and styling decisions independently. - Built the label's brand identity across digital platforms, producing a portfolio of campaign imagery and editorial content that articulates a distinct creative point of view.	
The Reach Brasserie <i>Bar Manager & Brand Implementation Lead</i>	London 2025 - Present
- Managed bar operations across service, suppliers and staff performance. Now leading the gradual rollout of brand work across menus, signage, content and the guest experience. - Designed and launched a curated seasonal cocktail offering, balancing creative concept development with cost efficiency and commercial viability.	
Oxford Fashion Gala <i>Co-Creative Director & Co-Marketing Director</i>	Oxford 2024 - 2025
- Appointed to lead the end-to-end creative vision for Oxford's largest annual fashion event, producing a thematically unified show by directing concept development, casting direction, set design, and choreography from brief to live performance. - Developed a multi-platform social campaign combining content, collaborations and a planned posting schedule; ticket sales increased from 2023 to 2024, the year I joined. - Delivered a cohesive campaign identity aligned with the Gala's creative vision, coordinating all audience-facing assets, copy, and promotional content across a team of volunteers.	
Levi Strauss <i>Stylist</i>	London 2025
Exceeded sales targets during Black Friday, one of retail's highest-pressure trading periods, by delivering personalised styling consultations that increased units per transaction (UPT) above the team benchmark.	

SELECTED PROJECTS

Tokyo Drift - Cultural Ethnography	Tokyo 2025
Produced a 10,000-word ethnography from three weeks of Tokyo fieldwork using participant observation, formal and semi-structured interviews, fieldnotes, and reflective journaling; analysed how sound, fashion, and movement shape subcultural identity.	
Bekaa - Hospitality Brand Strategy	Independent MA 2026
Combined cultural, competitor, and market research with audience definition, operational planning, and financial planning to develop positioning and recommendations for a differentiated listening-bar concept.	

SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES

Languages: English (fluent), French (working proficiency), Arabic - Lebanese dialect (intermediate)
Transferable Skills: Team leadership, project management, cross-functional collaboration, client-facing communication, budget awareness
Tools: Microsoft Office, PowerPoint, applied AI, Notion
Research & analysis: Stakeholder interviews, ethnography, user research, market and competitor research, structured synthesis, financial planning